

Curriculum Vitae

JUAN SEBASTIAN VASSALLO

www.juanvassallo.com

personal@juanvassallo.com



Field of artistic practice

Composer of instrumental and electronic music; live electronics improviser; pianist across diverse popular genres, including Argentine Tango and Jazz.

Academic and artistic research interests

Computer-assisted composition; electronic improvisation; artificial intelligence; music perception and cognition; cognition in music composition.

Education

2020-2025 – **Ph.D. in artistic research.** Grieg Academy of Music, University of Bergen.

2017-2019 – **Master's degree (interdisciplinary studies in music and psychology).**
University of Victoria (Canada).

2007-2013 – **Bachelor's in music composition** – National University of Córdoba (Argentina).

2002-2007 – **Diploma in piano** – Provincial Conservatory of Córdoba (Argentina)

Additional relevant training

2023 – **Certificate in Data Sciences.** Digital House Coding School. Buenos Aires (Argentina)

2021 – **Certificate in Full-Stack Web Development.** Digital House Coding School.

2010 – **Certificate in Cultural Management** – Universidad Nacional de Córdoba, Argentina.

Artistic CV (for audiovisual samples of my work, visit www.juanvassallo.com/compositions)

Recent/upcoming commissions

2026 – **Musical response to Op.88 No.2 by Anton Reicha** for wind quintet and piano, commissioned by Hanspeter Spannring (NL) and Steinar Hannevold (NO).

2026 – **Pu Werken / the messenger** for piano and electronics, commissioned by pianist Tore Eide Bordal (NO).

2025 – **Transmutation/the birth of the poem** for flute, saxophone, percussion, piano, and voice, commissioned by abeceda ensemble (SL).

2025 – **Frecuencia 76 – Memorial for the 50th anniversary of the Proceso de Reorganización Nacional (Argentina's last and most brutal dictatorship)**, for piano and electronics, commissioned by pianist Kesia Decote Rodrigues (BR/UK/NO), to be premiered at the Argentinian Embassy in Norway on March 24, 2026.

Outstanding collaborations with ensembles/soloists

2025 (upcoming) – **New Earth Ensemble (US)** – World premiere of the piece "Romance del Niño y el Agua" (text by A.E. Agüero). Loyola University in Chicago, October 12.

2025 – **Hinge Quartet (US)** – US premiere of *Oscillations/iii* at the ICMC 2025 conference. Northeastern University. Boston, June 12.

2025 – **Ludvig Lindström (FI)** – Concert and recording of the piece *Oscillations (i)* for voice and electronics.

2024-2025 – **Elide Sulsenti (IT)** – Premiere of the piece *Elevator Pitch* for cello and electronics, with performances in Bergen, Pistoia, Bologna, and Luzern.

2024 – **Lucas Fels (GER)** – Recording of the piece "Elevator Pitch" for cello and electronics.

- 2024** – **JÓR saxophone quartet (NO/SW/DK)**. Recording of the piece *I am a Strange Loop* for saxophone quartet and reeds duo.
- 2023** – **Obsidian (NO)** – performance of *Aphorisms/2* for string quartet at the festival Strings Attached 2024 (Bergen).
- 2022** – **Tabula Rasa (NO)** – performance of the piece *Versificator – Render 3* for vocal ensemble.
- 2022** – **Langhaughen string orchestra (NO)** – Performance of the piece *Evoluciones 2A* at Den Store Krapylkonserten (Bergen).
- 2021** – **Edvard Grieg Kor (NO)** – Recording of the piece *Isovell Che Segila Chentelare* for vocal octet.
- 2021** – **Schola Heidelberg (GE)** – Workshop and recording of the piece *Versificator – Render 3* for vocal quintet.
- 2012** – **Projecto RED ensemble (AR)**, performance and recording of *Trivium Jazz Cuyano* – funded by the UNESCO-Aschberg program.

Participation in contemporary music festivals

- 2023** – **Impuls 2023**. Piece: *Trivium*, performed by Zone Experimental Basel (CH).
- 2022** – **New Music Montreal (MNM)**. Piece: *I am a Strange Loop*, performed by Quasar Saxophone Quartet (CA).
- 2021** – **Festpillene i Bergen** (drop-in concerts). Piece: *Elevator Pitch (V1)*, performed by Kayleigh Neff (US).
- 2021** – **H&K Festival (Stavanger)**. Piece: *Oscillations (i)*, performed by Julie Hasfjord (NO) at Stavanger Konserthuset.

Published records

- 2024** – **‘I am a Strange Loop’** for saxophone quartet and reed duo. Available [here](#).
- 2023** – **‘Cinco Soles’** Juan S. Vassallo. Available [here](#).
- 2022** – **‘Semblanza’** Juan S. Vassallo. Available [here](#).
- 2021** – **‘Cyan’** ensemble Azul 514. Available [here](#).
- 2020** – **‘Azul 514’** Azul 514. Available [here](#).
- 2019** – **‘Atrevido’** by La Sanluistango. Available [here](#).
- 2017** – **‘A pesar del tiempo’** by La Sanluistango. Available [here](#).
- 2016** – **‘Amor adolescente’** by La Sanluistango. Available [here](#).

Artistic residencies

- 2026** – **Bergen Senter for Elektronik Kunst (BEK)**, Bergen (Norway).
- 2025** – **Festival precept.concept.percept XIII** (Slovenia).
- 2022** – **H&K Festival** (Stavanger).
- 2014** – **Center for Movement Research** (New York).
- 2012** – **Virginia Center for the Creative Arts (VCCA)**, Amherst, VA, USA.

Personal artistic awards

- 2024** – **1st Prize** in the AI-based composition contest at the IEEE Conference on Big Data in Washington, D.C. (2024). Piece: *Oscillations/iii*.
- 2019** – **Special Mention** at the 1st. Exhibition of Art and Technology, organized by the National Endowment of Arts of Argentina (Fondo Nacional de las Artes/FNA).
- 2013** – **Outstanding Award** in the 9th. Composition contest “Chengdu Sun River Prize” (Sichuan Conservatory, China), organized by the ISCM-International Society for Contemporary Music.
- 2013** – **Special Mention** in the Art Contest “In memory of the 30th Anniversary of the return of Democracy”. Organized by the City Council of Villa Mercedes (Argentina).
- 2012** – **Prix « Conseil du Pays de Calais »** – 1er. French-Argentine composition contest organized by the orchestra “Opal sinfonietta”, Boulogne-sur-Mer (France).

Member of music organizations

- 2023-2025** – Board member of **Avgarde Bergen** (Norway) <https://www.avgarde.no/>
2023 (ongoing) – Board member of **NyMusikk Bergen** (Norway) <https://nymusikkbergen.no/>
2024 – **NyMusikk Group of Composers** (Norway) <https://www.nmkomponistgruppe.no/>
2024 – **NOPA** (Norwegian Society of Composers and Writers) <https://nopa.no/>
2021 – **NKF** (Norwegian Society of Composers) <https://komponist.no>
2021 – **TONO** (Norwegian collective management company for copyright holders in musical works) <https://tono.no>

Academic CV (teaching experience, publications, conferences)

Teaching experience (at tertiary level)

- 2020-2025** – Artistic Research Fellow, The Grieg Academy (UiB, Norway); teaching included supervision (BA/MA) and courses in analysis, composition, piano, and computer-assisted composition.
2019 – Academic Tutor, Learning Assistance Program, University of Victoria (Canada).
2017-2018 – Teaching Assistant, UVic School of Music; assisted in music history, theory, choir, and resource room management.
2008-2017 – Instructor, IFDC VM (Argentina); Piano II (auxiliary 2008-14, lead instructor 2014-17).
2010 – Sessional Instructor, National University of La Rioja (Argentina); taught repertoire for singers and piano courses.
2010 – Adjunct Instructor, National University of Córdoba (Argentina); supervised composition students and led group lessons.

Selected academic publications

- Vassallo, J. (2025)** Outward Threads – Intuitive Computers / Rational Composers. Research Catalogue. Available [here](#).
Vassallo, J., Sandred, Ö., Vincenot, J. (2025) **NeuralConstraints: Integrating a Neural Generative Model with Constraint-Based Composition.** *Frontiers in Computer Sciences. Special Dossier: "Embodied Perspectives in Music and AI"*. Available [here](#).
Vassallo, J. (2024) **Exploring Musical Procedural Rhetoric: Computational Influence on Compositional Frameworks and Methods in the piece "Elevator Pitch".** *International Journal of Music Science, Technology and Art.* 6, 1-16. Available [here](#).
Vassallo, J. (2022). **Machinic automation in the process of text and music composition: The versificator.** *Proceedings of The 7th Colloquium on Artistic Research in Performing Arts.* Available [here](#).
Vassallo, J. (2019). **Music expert-novice differences in speech perception.** *University of Victoria Repository Dspace.* Available [here](#).

Guest speaker

- 2025 (upcoming)** – **Presentation at the Ligeti Center** (Hamburg) funded by DAAD.
2025 (upcoming) – **Presentation at the MetaCreation Lab** at Simon Fraser University (CA).
2025 (upcoming) – **Symposium "ARTILACS - Artistic Research, Artificial Intelligence and Latent Creative Spaces."** Organized by Lübeck University of Music.
2022 – **Inter Arts Center.** Malmö, Sweden. The lecture can be accessed [here](#).
2019 – **Cycle of talks: "Anfitriones de las Letras."** Casa de la Cultura Villa Mercedes (Argentina).

Selected contributions to international conferences

- 2025 (upcoming)** – **TENOR 2025.** Central Conservatory in Beijing, China. Paper: "MOZ'lib and PWforMax: rewriting CAC heritage."
2025 – **ICMC 2025.** Northeastern University. Boston, USA. Piece: "Oscillations/iii".

2024 - 12th IEEE International Conference on Big Data - Workshop on AI Music Generation (AIMG 2024). Washington, DC, USA. Awarded 1st prize in the composition contest.
2024 - EPARM 2024. Academy of Music, Ljubljana. Piece: "Oscillations (i)".
2023 - 14th SAR Conference "Too Early / Too Late." Norwegian University of Science and Technology (NTNU), Trondheim, Norway.
2022 - International Conference on Artistic Research "Various Fields, Approaches, Experiences." Jāzeps Vītols Latvian Academy of Music (JVLMA), Riga.
2021 - CARPA7 - "Elastic Writing in Artistic Research." UniArts Helsinki.

Peer review experience

2025 - *Paper reviewer for the TENOR conference.*
2025 - *The European Journal of Social Science Research (Routledge, Taylor Francis Group).*
2025 - *Frontiers in Computer Science, issue "Embodied Perspectives in Music and AI."*

Academic references

Dr. Dániel Péter Biró

Professor for Composition at The Grieg Academy, Faculty of Fine Art, Music and Design, University of Bergen.

Tel. +47 905 68 135

dpbiro@uib.no

www.danielpeterbiro.no

Prof. Örjan Sandred

Professor for Composition, Electronic and Computer Music at the Desautels Faculty of Music, University of Manitoba (Fort Garry Campus).

Tel. +1 204 474 9721

Orjan.Sandred@umanitoba.ca

<https://sandred.com>

Dr. W. Andrew Schloss

Emeritus Professor for Electronic and Computer Music, Acoustics, and Ethnomusicology. University of Victoria

aschloss@uvic.ca